



India Scholarships Statistics (2025-2026): 46+ Data Points on Budget Allocations, Corporate CSR Schemes, and International Student Mobility

Updated 2026-07-24 By IndiaScholarships Editorial Team

KEY TAKEAWAYS (QUICK SUMMARY)

- Central assistance under the SC Post-Matric Scholarship reached ₹6,208.08 Crore in FY26, supporting 47.53 lakh students.
- Reliance Foundation selected 5,100 scholars in the 2025-26 cycle, receiving over 1.25 lakh undergraduate and postgraduate applications.
- Outbound Indian student mobility stabilized at 626,000 in 2025 due to visa changes in traditional destinations.

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Official Stat Report (FY 2025-2026)

SC POST-MATRIC FUNDING

₹6,208.08 Cr

HIGHER ED ENROLMENT

45 Million

OUTBOUND STUDENTS (2025)

626,000

Key Education Scholarship Trends in India

India's scholarship landscape saw major disbursements in the 2025-26 academic cycle. The central government released ₹6,208.08 Crore for Scheduled Caste students. Private entities like Reliance Foundation selected 5,100 fresh scholars from massive application pools. Over 626,000 Indian students studied abroad under changing international visa and funding rules.

Data from the Press Information Bureau, Ministry of Education, and corporate reports show key trends. This report compiles the latest primary datasets to analyze funding shifts.

1. Central Government Scholarship Funding & Budget Allocations

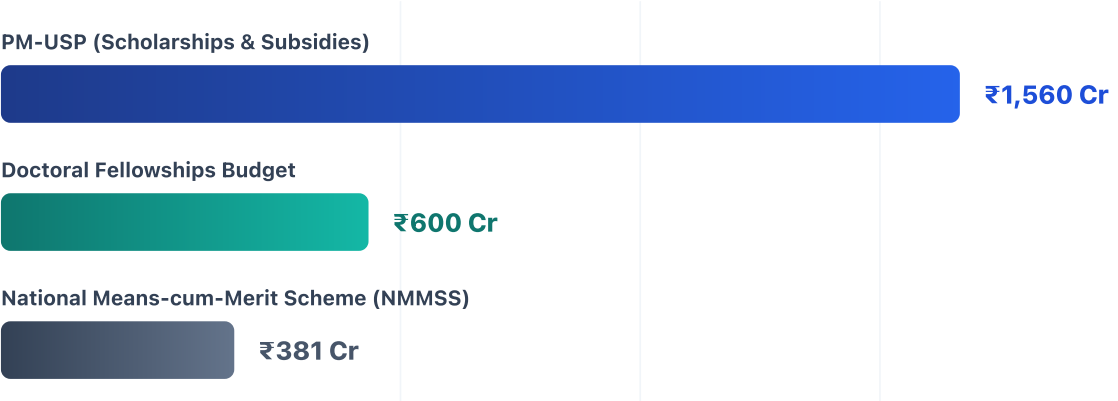
National budget outlays show targeted support for higher education programs and merit subsidies. Spending through schemes like PM-USP focuses on professional training and interest reliefs.

Economically weaker sections receive stable funding to prevent secondary school dropouts.

Students looking for central funding options can view the [Government Scholarships Page](#).

Central Scholarship Allocations (FY27)

Budget outlays for major central education funding schemes (₹ Crore)



Source: Union Budget of India (Demand for Grants for Ministry of Education)

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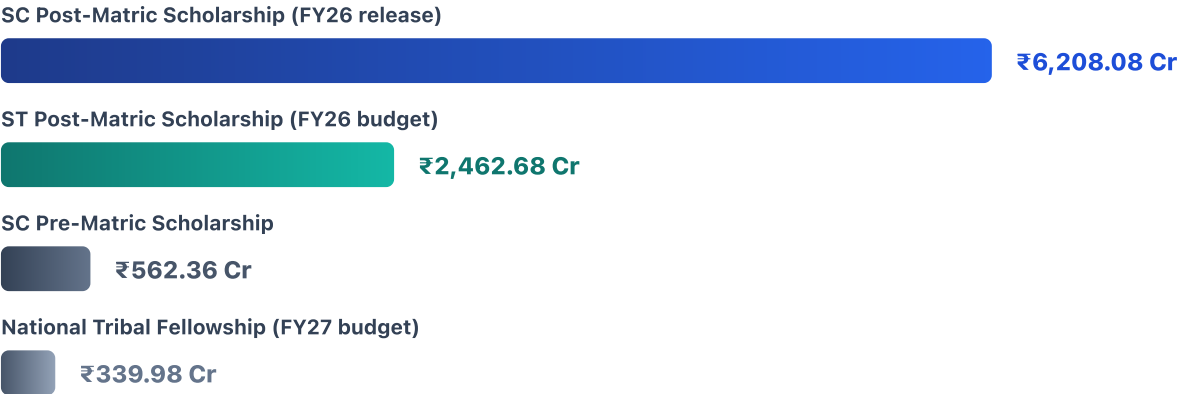
METRIC	VALUE	SOURCE
PM-USP (Scholarships & Interest Subsidies) Outlay (FY27)	₹1,560 Crore	Union Budget (Demand 26) (2026)
National Means-cum-Merit Scheme Allocation (FY27)	₹381 Crore	Union Budget (Demand 26) (2026)
NMMSS Five-Year Approved Outlay (2021-2026)	₹1,827 Crore	Press Information Bureau Releases (2026)
National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Annual Rate	₹12,000 / year	MyScheme Portal Official (2026)
Financial Aid Increase Over FY26 Revised Estimates	24%	PRS Legislative Budget Analysis (2026)
Total Doctoral Fellowship Budget Allocation (FY27)	₹600 Crore	Union Budget (Demand 26) (2026)

2. National SC and ST Scholarship Allocations

Central assistance for Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe students shows substantial volume expansion. The government plans to raise the family income limit to expand scheme coverage. Awareness campaigns receive dedicated funds to help remote student groups access benefits.

SC / ST National Scheme Funding

Central assistance released and outlays by scheme (₹ Crore)



METRIC	VALUE	SOURCE
SC Post-Matric Scholarship Central Share (FY26)	₹6,208.08 Crore	Press Information Bureau Releases (2026)
SC Post-Matric Scholarship Total Beneficiaries	47.53 Lakh	Press Information Bureau Releases (2026)
SC Pre-Matric Scholarship Central Assistance	₹562.36 Crore	Press Information Bureau Releases (2026)
SC Pre-Matric Scholarship Total Beneficiaries	26.79 Lakh	Press Information Bureau Releases (2026)
ST Post-Matric Scholarship Budget (FY26)	₹2,462.68 Crore	Ministry of Tribal Affairs Reports (2026)
Proposed Family Income Limit for SC/ST Scholarships	₹4.5 Lakh	The Hindu Education News (2026)
National Tribal Fellowship Budget Allocation (FY27)	₹339.98 Crore	Ministry of Tribal Affairs Scheme Allocations (2026)

3. State-Level Scholarship Portal Tracking and Disbursements

State portals utilize Aadhaar-seeded accounts to process student applications directly through bank transfers. Saksham portal data in Uttar Pradesh shows high overall registration volumes. Small states like Nagaland also report successful Aadhaar-enabled payments to tribal groups.

Students can trace their application status using our [NSP Portal Guide](#).

UP Saksham Portal Application Funnel

Volume drop-off from OTR registration to final DBT payment (Lakh Students)



Source: Saksham Portal Official Dashboard (Uttar Pradesh State Government, July 2026 data)

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METRIC	VALUE	SOURCE
UP Saksham Portal Total OTR Registrations (FY26)	89.89 Lakh	UP Saksham Portal Stats Dashboard (2026)
UP Saksham Portal Final Submitted Applications	84.88 Lakh	UP Saksham Portal Stats Dashboard (2026)
UP Saksham Portal Total Paid Beneficiaries	18.64 Lakh	UP Saksham Portal Stats Dashboard (2026)
UP State Total Scholarship Outlay Distributed	₹2,825 Crore	News On Air State Briefings (2026)
Nagaland ST Post-Matric Scheme Disbursements	₹254.98 Crore	Nagaland Department of Higher Education (2026)
Nagaland ST Post-Matric Total Beneficiaries	40,791	Nagaland Post State News (2026)

4. Corporate CSR and Private Philanthropic Initiatives

Corporate social responsibility rules make education a primary focus area for private firms. Large foundations offer structured funding for undergraduate and postgraduate studies. Selection processes are competitive, relying on academic merit and low family incomes.

Students looking for private funding can view the [Corporate Scholarships Page](#).

Corporate & Private Scholarship Grant Sizes

Comparison of maximum annual funding limits per student (₹ Rupees)



Source: Reliance Foundation Scholarship Announcement and HDFC Bank Parivartan ECSS program details

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METRIC	VALUE	SOURCE
Total Indian CSR Spending for FY25	₹40,794 Crore	Ministry of Corporate Affairs CSR Portal (2025)
Education Sector Share of Annual CSR Expenditure	25% to 44%	CSRBOX India CSR Reports (2025)
Reliance Foundation Total Selected Scholars (FY26)	5,100	Reliance Foundation Scholars Page (2025)
Reliance UG Scholarship Grant Limit	Up to ₹2 Lakh	Reliance Foundation Scholars Page (2025)
Reliance PG Scholarship Grant Limit	Up to ₹6 Lakh	Reliance Foundation Scholars Page (2025)
HDFC Parivartan ECSS General UG Scholarship Rate	₹30,000 / year	HDFC Bank Parivartan Program (2025)
HDFC Parivartan ECSS Professional PG Scholarship Rate	₹75,000 / year	HDFC Bank Parivartan Program (2025)

5. Elite International Scholarships for Indian Students

Prestigious global scholarships offer full funding cover to talented Indian students. India remains a top recipient country for European Union study fellowships. Overseas funding programs for marginalized groups are also increasing their student intakes.

Students can verify their foreign scholarship match on the [Eligibility Checker Tool](#).

Elite International Scholarship Slots (India)

Number of annual selection slots allocated for Indian students



Source: Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, European Union Delegation to India, Rhodes Trust

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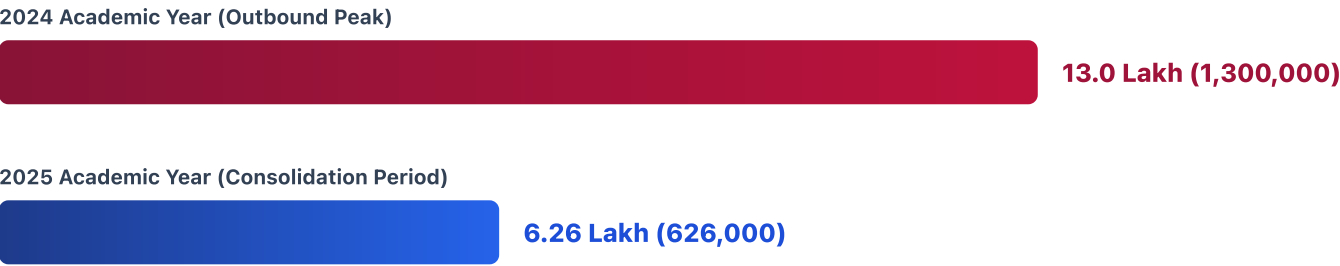
Metric	Value	Source
Erasmus Mundus Indian Scholarship Awardees (2026)	75	EU Delegation to India Releases (2026)
Erasmus Mundus Indian Scholarship Awardees (2025)	101	EU Delegation to India Releases (2025)
Rhodes Scholars Selected from India (2026 Cohort)	6	Rhodes House Class Archives (2026)
National Overseas Scholarship ST Slots (FY27 Plan)	50	Ministry of Tribal Affairs NOS Portal (2026)
National Overseas Scholarship SC Slots (FY27 Plan)	250	Ministry of Social Justice NOS Scheme (2026)
National Overseas Scholarship SC Selected Candidates (FY26)	106	Ministry of Social Justice NOS Scheme (2026)
National Overseas Scholarship ST Annual Budget (FY27)	₹20 Crore	Ministry of Tribal Affairs NOS Portal (2026)

6. Outbound Student Mobility and Study Abroad Trends

Changing immigration rules in host countries have stabilized the student outflow from India. Rising tuition costs make return on investment a vital decision factor. Outbound student flows are projected to sustain a moderate growth rate over the decade.

Outbound Indian Student Flow (2024-2025)

Total number of Indian students traveling abroad for studies (Lakh Students)



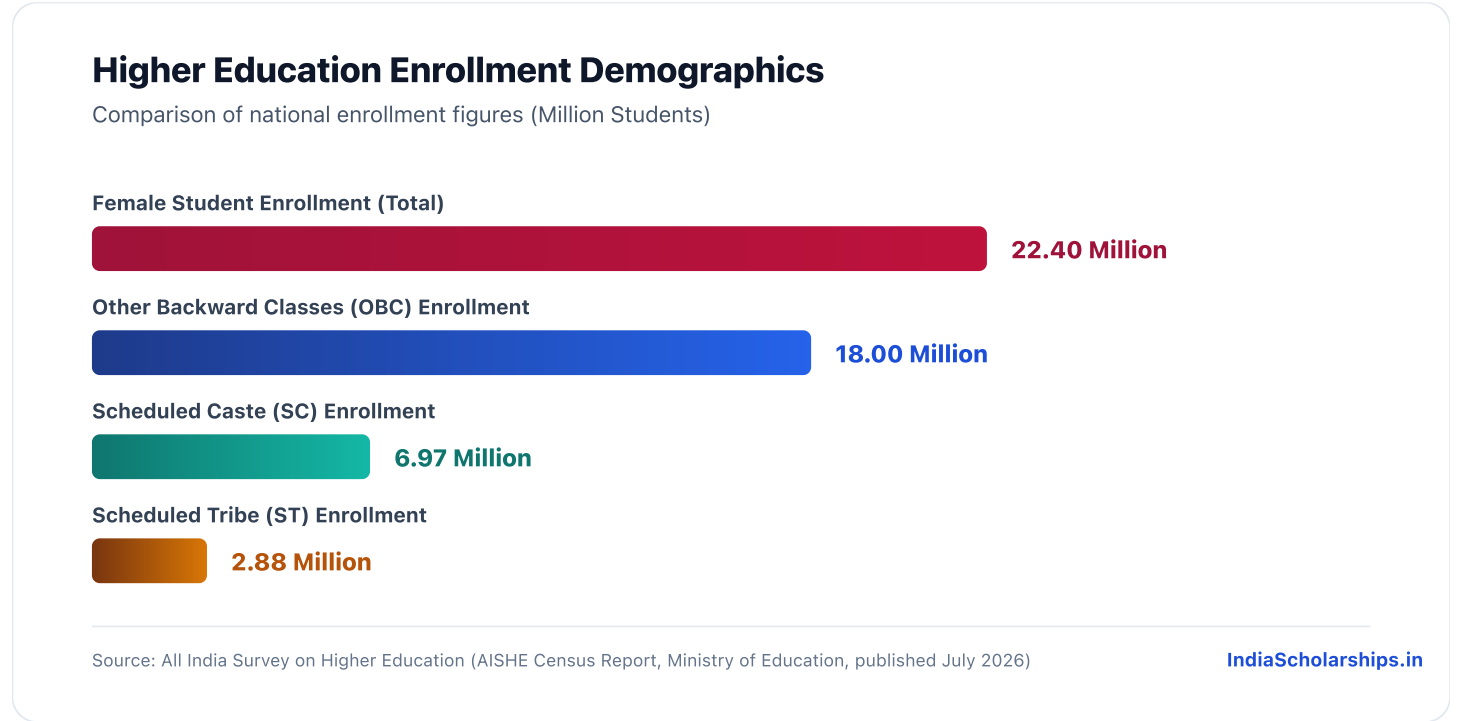
Source: Ministry of Education, Government of India (Provisional Outbound Mobility Records)

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Metric	Value	Source
Total Outbound Indian Students Abroad (2025)	626,000	Ministry of Education Statistics (2025)
Indian Undergraduate Applications to UK (2026 Cycle)	6.9% Increase	UCAS Corporate Key Facts (2026)
QS Flow Outbound Indian Student Growth Forecast	4% annually	QS Global Student Flow Reports (2026)
Canada New Study Permit Reduction Rate	80% to 90%	The PIE News Canada Cap Coverage (2025)
Historical Inception USIEF Total Grants	20,000 to 33,000+	USIEF Fulbright-Nehru Fellowships (2026)

7. Higher Education Enrollment & Demographic Indicators

Higher education parameters in India show overall expansion in student participation. Female participation index values remain strong across multiple cycles. Marginalized social groups show steady enrollment increases under the national policy.



METRIC	VALUE	SOURCE
Total Student Enrolment in Higher Education	45 Million	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)
Gross Enrolment Ratio in Higher Education (18-23 Age)	30	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)
Total Female Student Higher Education Enrolment	22.4 Million	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)
Gender Parity Index in Higher Education	1.08	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)
Scheduled Caste Enrolment Total	69.72 Lakh	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)
Scheduled Tribe Enrolment Total	28.83 Lakh	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)
Other Backward Classes Enrolment Total	1.80 Crore	AISHE Annual Survey Reports (2026)

India Scholarships by the Numbers: Summary Table

The table below compiles the highest-impact statistics on Indian education funding and student mobility.

Metric Area	Value	Source
SC Post-Matric Scholarship Central Outlay (FY26)	₹6,208.08 Crore	Press Information Bureau
UP Saksham Portal Total OTR Registrations (FY26)	89.89 Lakh	UP Saksham Portal
Total Student Enrolment in Higher Education	45 Million	AISHE Census Report
Total Outbound Indian Students Abroad (2025)	626,000	Ministry of Education
Reliance Foundation Total Selected Scholars (FY26)	5,100	Reliance Foundation
PM-USP (Scholarships & Subsidies) Outlay (FY27)	₹1,560 Crore	India Budget
ST Post-Matric Scholarship Budget (FY26)	₹2,462.68 Crore	Ministry of Tribal Affairs
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Total Indian CSR Spending for FY25	₹40,794 Crore	Ministry of Corporate Affairs
Erasmus Mundus Indian Scholarship Awardees (2025)	101	European Union Delegation

Metric Area	Value	Source
National Means-cum-Merit Scheme Allocation (FY27)	₹381 Crore	India Budget
National Tribal Fellowship Budget Allocation (FY27)	₹339.98 Crore	Ministry of Tribal Affairs
National Overseas Scholarship SC Slots (FY27 Plan)	250	Ministry of Social Justice

Methodology and Sources

All metrics are aggregated from official and verified primary sources:

- **Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education:** AISHE Reports (2023-2024 published July 2026).
- **Ministry of Finance:** Union Budget Demand for Grants and Expenditure Profiles (2026-2027).
- **Ministry of Corporate Affairs:** CSR spending datasets (2024-2025).
- **Ministry of Tribal Affairs & Ministry of Social Justice:** National Overseas Scholarship guidelines and fellowship disbursements.
- **Press Information Bureau (PIB):** Official press releases and departmental updates.
- **State Education Portals:** UP Saksham statistical dashboard, Nagaland Higher Education reports.
- **Corporate Foundations:** Reliance Foundation Annual Statements, HDFC Bank CSR impact reports.
- **International Bodies:** European Union Delegation to India releases, Rhodes Trust scholar archives.

Last updated: July 2026. We update this page quarterly to ensure accuracy.

Reference Document Readiness Checklist

Check off items as you gather documents to verify these statistics:

Review family annual income thresholds across government and private portals.

Verify your Aadhaar-seeding status via the official NPCI mapping tool before applying.

Prepare standard academic marks transcripts and active mobile linkage.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

How much scholarship money does India spend on SC students?

The central government disbursed ₹6,208.08 Crore in central assistance for the SC Post-Matric Scholarship in the FY 2025-2026 cycle.

How many Indian students study abroad in 2025?

Approximately 626,000 Indian students studied abroad for higher education in 2025, showing consolidation compared to the previous year.

What is the parental income limit proposed for SC/ST national scholarships?

The central government has proposed raising the parental annual income threshold limit from ₹2.5 lakh to ₹4.5 lakh starting in the FY 2026-27 session.

What is the annual rate of the National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship (NMMSS)?

The National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship (NMMSS) is awarded at an annual rate of ₹12,000 per year for students from class 9 to 12.

How many scholarship slots does the Reliance Foundation award annually?

In the FY 2025-26 cycle, the Reliance Foundation selected 5,100 scholars (undergraduate and postgraduate combined) under its private philanthropic scholarship program.

What is the funding limit for the Reliance Foundation Postgraduate scholarship?

The Reliance Foundation Postgraduate Scholarship provides funding cover up to ₹6 Lakh per year for professional PG studies.

What are the slot allocations for Scheduled Caste students in the National Overseas Scholarship (NOS) plan?

The Ministry of Social Justice allocates 250 candidate slots annually for SC students under the National Overseas Scholarship plan for higher education abroad.

FEATURED SCHOLARSHIPS MENTIONED IN THIS GUIDE

ALL INDIA

Reliance Foundation Undergraduate Scholarship

₹50,000/year

ALL INDIA

HDFC Bank Parivartan's Educational Crisis Scholarship Support (ECSS) Programme...

₹75,000/year

ALL INDIA

National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship (NMMS)

₹12,000/year

Official Government Portal Source Reference. Information cross-checked with state guidelines.



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